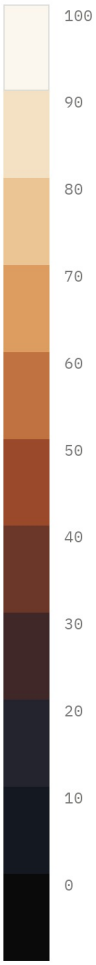
Plates from a Collection

How a folder of pictures becomes a matched set of plates, and the plates become a book.





Cover
Plate 00 from plate-book.json (run 2, seed 20261103), mapped by brightness to the seven tones at right. AI-generated.

Brightness, %

The prompt

“Four objects from a museum’s open collection, each one photographed as a specimen on black. Make them into a short manual: what the objects are, how to ask a model for a plate, and how to keep a set of plates looking like one book.”

Collection	Four museum photographs, all public domain (CC0) from The Metropolitan Museum of Art Open Access: a faience hippopotamus, a netsuke, a watch and a toy. The first three went into the workflow.
Plates	Five plates from one run of plate-book.json on Comfy Cloud (Qwen-Image-Edit-2511, an open-weight model, Lightning 4-step, seed 20261103): a cover, one plate per object and a group plate. Every generated picture is marked AI-generated in its caption.
Layout	Set by make_book.py from this prompt, the folder of images and a spec file. Same inputs, same book.

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Collection

01

Four objects from one museum

The collection this book starts from.

01 **Public domain only**
Every object here is released CC0 by The Metropolitan Museum of Art. Check the licence before a photo goes into the folder.

02 **One object per photo**
A single thing on a plain ground. The model keeps whatever else is in the frame, labels and rulers included.

03 **Keep the museum's light**
Collection photos already show shape and material clearly. Do not re-light or retouch them first.

04 **Write down what it is**
Name, place, date, accession number. The caption is also the first line of the prompt.



Object 1
Hippopotamus (“William”), Egypt, ca. 1961–1878 B.C. Met 17.9.1. CC0.



Object 2
Netsuke, Japan, 18th century. Met 10.211.2273. CC0.



Object 3
Watch, ca. 1630–40, Johann Possdorfer. Met 17.190.1525. CC0.



Object 4
Toy, China, 19th century. Met 67.179.18a, b. CC0. Cropped above the museum label. Not used in the run (the workflow takes three objects).

Collection

02

Read the object before you prompt

What to look at first, so you can ask for it by name.

01 **Shape**
Seated, coiled, round, flat. One word for the silhouette keeps it from drifting.

02 **Material**
Boxwood, faience, rock crystal, silk. Name it; the model renders surfaces by their names.

03 **Size**
Say how big it is: this netsuke fits in a palm. Without a size the model picks one.

04 **What must not change**
List it first in the prompt: the face, the carving, the colour of the wood.



Object 2
Netsuke, Japan, 18th century. Carved wood, palm-sized. Met 10.211.2273. CC0.

Prompting

03

Six rules for a plate

Follow these for every picture in the set.

01

Say what stays

Begin with what must not change: the object’s exact shape, colour and material.

02

One ground for the whole book

Pure seamless black. Paste the same words into every prompt.

03

One light

A large soft key from above left, a thin rim, no fill. Shadows stay deep and clean.



Object 3
Watch, ca. 1630–40. Rock crystal case, enamelled dial. Met 17.190.1525. CC0.

04

Fix the seed

Use one seed for the set, so a change in the picture comes from a change in the words.

05

Give it a size

Toy scale, palm-sized, 4 cm across. Scale words change the lens the model imagines.

06

Set the type yourself

Models garble small lettering. Ask for blank panels and set every title and caption in layout, as this book does.

Prompting

04

One object per plate

A plate is made from its own object alone.

01 **What run 1 did**
Each object plate also took the cover as image 2, as a lighting reference. For object 3 the model copied the cover hippo into the plate instead of the watch.

02 **The fix**
Run 2 feeds each plate only its own object. The shared House look text carries the light, ground and camera.

03 **What held**
With one seed and one House look, the three plates still share a black ground and a soft key from above left.

04 **Keep the reject**
The run 1 plate is kept as a record of the failure. It is not used anywhere else in this book.



Input Object 3
Watch, as photographed. Met 17.190.1525. CC0.



Run 1 Rejected
Plate 03 with the cover as image 2: the watch is gone, the hippo came back. AI-generated.



Run 2 Seed 20261103
Plate 03 from the watch alone. AI-generated.

Series

05

A plate on black

One object, one light, nothing else in the frame.

01 **Why black**
It drops the room. Every plate in a set can sit on the same ground, so they read as one series.

02 **Leave space**
Ask for the object small in the frame. Cropping in later is easy; the model cannot add black it never drew.

03 **Check the edges**
Look for halos and grey fog where the ground should be flat. Reject, do not retouch.

04 **Keep the record**
ComfyUI writes the whole graph into each PNG. Drop one back onto the canvas to get every setting back.



Plate 02 Seed 20261103
plate-book.json, run 2: the netsuke.
Qwen-Image-Edit-2511, Lightning, 4 steps, CFG 1. AI-generated.

Series

06

Three objects, one ground

One seed and one House look across the set.

01 **Same words**
Every plate prompt is the plate instruction, then the House look, then the Book prompt. Only the first part changes.

02 **One seed**
All five plates use seed 20261103, so a change in a plate comes from its words or its input.

03 **What held**
Black ground, a soft key from above left and a deep shadow under each object carry through all three plates.

04 **What varied**
Size: each plate keeps the shape of its input photo, scaled to the nearest preset, so the hippo is portrait, the netsuke landscape and the watch square.



Plate 01
The hippo. AI-generated.



Plate 02
The netsuke. AI-generated.



Plate 03
The watch. AI-generated.

Series

07

The group plate

The three plates, set out together.

01 **Plates in, not photos**
The group plate takes plates 01, 02 and 03 as images 1, 2 and 3, so the objects arrive already lit and cut out.

02 **What held**
All three objects are present and recognisable: glaze pattern, carving and the enamelled dial.

03 **What drifted**
The model added a dark tray with a curved rim. The prompt asked for objects like specimens on a museum tray, and it took the words literally.

04 **Not retouched**
Faint white specks sit in the lower third of the black ground. They are in the raw output and were left as they are.



Plate 04 Seed 20261103
plate-book.json, run 2: group plate made from plates 01–03. Raw output, not retouched. AI-generated.

Series

08

Choosing the cover

One plate, mapped by brightness to a short scale of tones.

01 **Brightness only**
The plate is turned to grey, then each grey is given a colour from the scale. Hue in the original is ignored.

02 **Seven tones**
Near-black, ink blue, oxblood, rust, amber, sand, paper. The scale is printed beside the cover so the mapping can be read.

03 **Dark plates work best**
A specimen on black puts most of the picture in the lowest tones, so the object glows in the warm ones.

04 **Change the scale**
Edit tone_scale in the spec. Any number of tones, darkest first.



Before
Plate 00 from plate-book.json, as generated. AI-generated.



After
The same picture mapped to the cover scale by make_book.py.

Make it

09

From a folder to a book

Run the workflow, then the layout script.

01

Collect

Put up to three object photos in ComfyUI/input as collection_01.png to collection_03.png.

02

Write the prompt

One paragraph on what the book is about. It goes into the Book prompt box and onto page 2.

03

Run plate-book.json

One run makes a cover plate, one plate per object and a group plate, all on black.

04

Pick

Keep the plates that pass the checks in chapter 05. Run again with a new seed, or change the words, for the rest.

05

Caption

Write a label and a line for each image in book.json, with its seed and source.

06

Build

python scripts/make_book.py --spec book.json --images folder --out out. A PDF and spreads come out.

Colophon

Type	Inter by Rasmus Andersson and IBM Plex Mono by IBM, both under the SIL Open Font License 1.1.
Pictures	Collection photographs: The Metropolitan Museum of Art, Open Access, CC0. Generated pictures: one run of plate-book.json on Comfy Cloud, 2026-11-03, Qwen-Image-Edit-2511 with Qwen2.5-VL and the Lightning 4-step LoRA, open weights under Apache-2.0, seed 20261103; plus one rejected plate from an earlier run, marked as such. All generated pictures are AI-generated.
Layout	make_book.py, Apache-2.0. Page 170 × 240 mm, six columns, 300 dpi. Same inputs, same file.

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End